Team Charter

Agree why the team exists, how it works together, and what Ready and Done mean, before the work starts.

Team Formation · Working Agreements · Definition of Ready & Done · Review It as the Team Changes

TEAM _____

DATE _____

1 Purpose

WHY DOES THIS TEAM EXIST?

We exist to... _____

for... _____

We succeed when... _____

2 Members & Roles

NAME	ROLE	WHAT I BRING

3 Our Values

WHAT MATTERS TO US

- 3–5 values, each with an example of it in action

Add your sticky notes here

4 Working Agreements

WE AGREE TO…

- Communication, core hours, meetings, feedback, how we handle interruptions

One agreement per sticky, written as "We…"

5 How We Decide

- ☐ Consent: no one objects
- ☐ Consensus: everyone agrees
- ☐ Majority vote
- ☐ Consult, then one person decides
- ☐ Delegated to an owner

Default method, and who decides what:

_____

6 Ways of Working

CADENCE & TOOLS

Iteration length: _____

Planning: _____

Daily sync: _____

Review: _____

Retro: _____

Board / tools: _____

Channels: _____

7 Definition of Ready

BEFORE WE START AN ITEM

e.g. value is clear, it's small enough, examples agreed

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

8 Definition of Done

BEFORE WE CALL IT DONE

e.g. tested, reviewed, documented, releasable

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

9 Conflict & Review

When we disagree, we...

_____

_____

We review this charter:

☐ Every quarter ☐ When someone joins ☐ When it stops working

Signed by the team: _____

"What would make this the best team any of us has worked on?"

"Which of these agreements will we find hardest to keep?"

© 2026 Eric Parker · CC BY 4.0 · eparker71.github.io/agile-ways-of-working